NCCP 00815 · VERSION 3

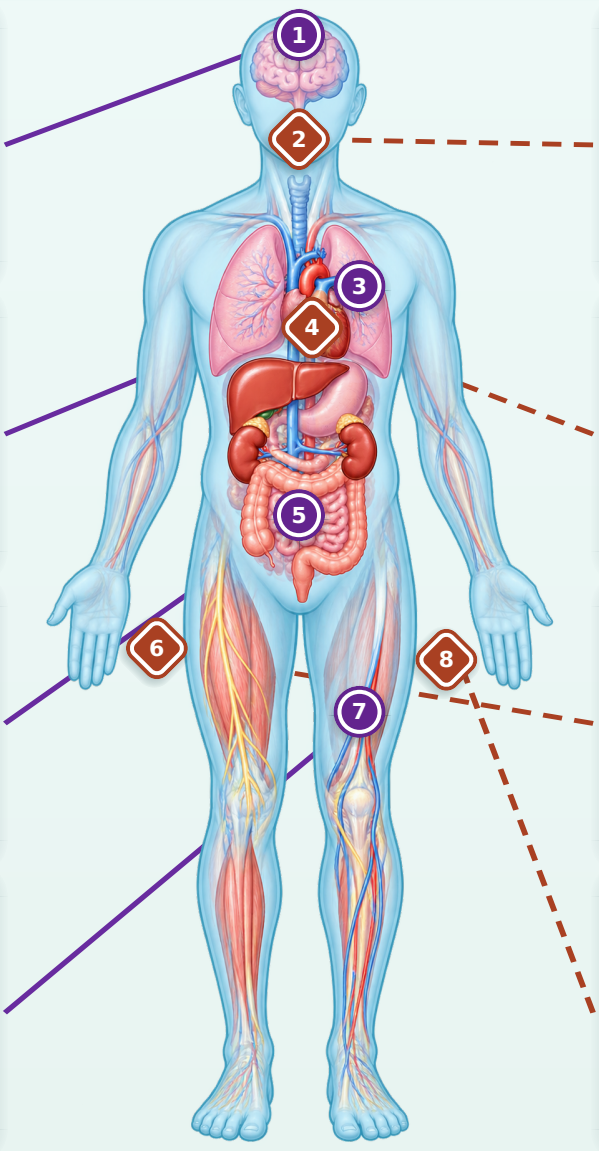
Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Paclitaxel weekly for 12 doses with trastuzumab every 3 weeks; continue trastuzumab to complete one year of HER2 treatment when appropriate.

Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.



1 Hair / scalp

Chemotherapy

Hair loss or thinning varies; ask about support.

2 Mouth

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

3 Breathing

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

New cough or breathlessness needs prompt assessment.

4 Heart

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

New chest pain, fainting or severe breathlessness needs urgent assessment.

5 Bowel

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Report diarrhoea early, especially with poor intake or dizziness.

6 Nerves / joints

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Report numbness, tingling or pain affecting daily activity.

7 Blood / infection

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Fever, shivers, unusual bleeding or sudden illness: call promptly.

8 Skin / liver symptoms

Weekly paclitaxel + trastuzumab → trastuzumab continuation

Report severe rash, blistering or yellow skin / eyes promptly.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

Support for this phase

Paclitaxel has premedicines and low-risk antiemetic support. Trastuzumab continuation needs a separate minimal-risk plan; chemotherapy premedicines must not carry over automatically.

Bloods and cardiac checks

FBC, kidney/liver tests → Before each weekly chemotherapy dose → According to clinical status / ongoing treatment. Continue the same surveillance clock.

Visits and practical support

Ask about travel, work, fertility, menopause, exercise and help at home. The team arranges and reviews clinical checks; the patient should not have to calculate the monitoring timetable.

Follow-up and bone health

If an aromatase inhibitor or ovarian suppression is prescribed, assess fracture risk and baseline DEXA as indicated. Repeat timing depends on the result, risk and bone treatment; it is not an automatic scan for everyone.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

087 181 9645

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

021 4922000

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00815/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.